



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Large-Scale Credential Attacks Against Security and Edge Devices

Threat Intelligence Report

Classification	TLP:CLEAR
Published	2026-06-22
Version	1.0
Author	Lost Boys Cyber
Report Type	Threat Intelligence Report

TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Large-Scale Credential Attacks Against Security and Edge Devices - Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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Large-Scale Credential Attacks Against Security and Edge Devices

1. Executive Summary

Unit 42 published mitigation guidance for large-scale credential attacks with emphasis on security-vendor and edge-device exposure. This item is selected because credential attacks against VPN, firewall, MSSQL, and remote-access surfaces are immediately actionable and often precede ransomware, data theft, or cloud account compromise.

This report was produced from current public reporting available during the 2026-06-22 UTC automation window. It does not add unverified IOCs or attribution claims beyond the cited sources.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Question	Current Answer	Confidence
Who is affected?	Security appliances, VPN/edge infrastructure, MSSQL, Sophos/Fortinet-like remote-access surfaces per public summaries.	Medium
What should defenders prioritize?	Hunt for the behavioral signals and control-plane activity described in Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting.	High
Are hard IOCs available in the selected sources?	Not consistently available from accessible source snippets during this run; this report emphasizes behavior-based detection and source links.	Medium

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Unit 42	Primary threat brief and mitigation guidance	High
QFeeds summary	Secondary summary referencing Fortinet and other targets	Medium
Unit 42 Incident Response Report	Strategic context on identity weakness and attack speed	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

The public reporting emphasizes password spraying and credential theft at scale rather than a single CVE. Defenders should prioritize identity telemetry, device authentication logs, MFA enforcement, and stale local/VPN accounts on internet-facing systems.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic / Phase	Observed Technique	Evidence
Initial Access	Valid accounts and password spraying	Large-scale credential attack pattern
Defense Evasion	Use of legitimate login paths	Authentication attempts blend into normal access flows

Persistence	Reuse of valid accounts or device sessions	Compromised credentials can persist beyond password rotation gaps
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6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Indicator / Infrastructure	Type	Operational Use
No durable hard IOC published in extracted snippets	Source limitation	Use cited primary reports for any latest hashes/domains and prefer behavior hunts below.
Target-facing legitimate services	Abuse surface	Adversaries use normal web, identity, repository, advertising, or email workflows depending on campaign.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Security appliances, VPN/edge infrastructure, MSSQL, Sophos/Fortinet-like remote-access surfaces per public summaries.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
New administrative rule, repository, installer, or authentication pattern inconsistent with baseline	Identity, SaaS, EDR, proxy	Surface initial access or control-plane abuse.
Script or binary execution shortly after user interaction with a lure or exposed service	EDR process telemetry	Identify payload staging and hands-on-keyboard follow-through.
External transfer or suspicious sign-in following initial signal	Network, cloud audit, identity	Detect collection/exfiltration or account takeover.

8.2. Sigma / Detection Content

<pre> title: Suspicious Campaign Follow-On Activity - unit42-large-scale-credential-attacks status: experimental description: Behavioral analytic for campaign-aligned suspicious execution, authentication, or control-plane changes. Tune service names to the environment and campaign. logsource: category: process_creation detection: selection_scripting: Image endswith: - \powershell.exe - \cmd.exe - \wscript.exe - \cscript.exe - \python.exe - /bin/sh - /bin/bash selection_lure_context: CommandLine contains: - git clone - npm install - curl - wget - encodedcommand - Add-MailboxRule </pre>

```

- Set-TransportRule
  condition: selection_scripting and selection_lure_context
fields:
- Image
- CommandLine
- ParentImage
- User
- Computer
falsepositives:
- Developer administration and approved automation; require owner validation.
level: medium

```

8.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("git clone", "npm install", "curl", "wget", "Add-MailboxRule",
"Set-TransportRule", "powershell -enc")
| where InitiatingProcessFileName has_any ("chrome.exe", "msedge.exe", "firefox.exe", "outlook.exe",
"teams.exe", "powershell.exe", "cmd.exe")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine

```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypothesis

Surges of failed authentication across many accounts, rare geographies against edge devices, and successful login immediately after spraying.

9.2. Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName has_any ("powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "python.exe", "node.exe",
"git.exe", "java.exe", "splunkd.exe")
| summarize connections=count(), first_seen=min(Timestamp), last_seen=max(Timestamp),
remote_count=dcount(RemoteUrl) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
AccountName
| where connections > 10 or remote_count > 3

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(30d)
| summarize failures=countif(ResultType != 0), successes=countif(ResultType == 0),
countries=dcount(Location) by UserPrincipalName, AppDisplayName, IPAddress
| where failures > 20 or (successes > 0 and countries > 2)

```

10. Risk Assessment

Dimension	Assessment	Rationale
Likelihood	Medium to High	Selected because reporting is recent and defender-actionable.
Impact	High	Campaigns affect identity, research data, developer systems, or credential stores.
Confidence	medium	Based on primary/vendor reporting and corroborating public coverage.

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	SOC	Run the included hunts against identity,

		endpoint, proxy, and SaaS logs.
High	Platform / identity owners	Reduce exposed administrative surfaces and enforce phishing-resistant MFA where supported.
High	Endpoint team	Review application allowlists, browser-download controls, and developer workstation monitoring.
Medium	Threat intel	Monitor the cited primary reports for newly published IOCs and update sidecar files.

12. References

- [Unit 42] <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/large-scale-credential-attacks/>
- [QFeeds summary] <https://qfeeds.com/understanding-the-landscape-strategies-to-combat-large-scale-credential-attacks/>
- [Unit 42 Incident Response Report] <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/2026-incident-response-report/>